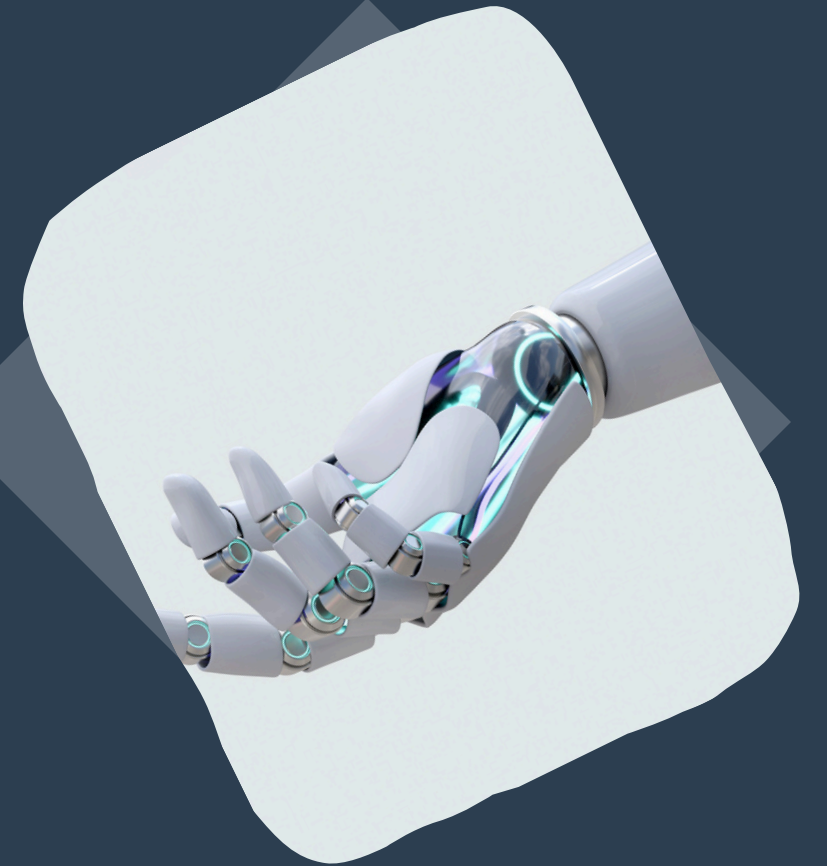


I let an AI agent run my day



Testing New AI Technology

Article: "Flashes of brilliance and frustration:
I let an AI agent run my day"

Author: Chris Stokel-Walker

Source: New Scientist, 8 July 2025

STOKEL-WALKER C., (8 July 2025), Flashes of brilliance and frustration: I let an AI agent run my day,
New Scientist



Hassen KHLIFI:

Flashes of brilliance and frustration: I let an AI agent run my day

The article by Chris Stokel-Walker describes his experience testing AI agents, which are new AI assistants that can complete tasks automatically rather than just providing information. The writer tested two AI agents called Operator and Manus by asking them to do everyday work tasks such as ordering food, sending emails, and managing invoices. While the AI agents showed some success, they also made many mistakes including writing poor emails, filling forms incorrectly, and creating work that needed constant supervision. The article explores serious concerns about security and privacy, as AI agents require access to personal information like passwords and credit cards, making them vulnerable to attacks. Experts interviewed explain that AI agents can be easily tricked and may work for companies rather than users. The article concludes that while AI agents show promise for the future, current versions are not reliable or safe enough for everyday use and require significant improvement before people can trust them with important tasks.

STOKEL-WALKER C., (8 July 2025), Flashes of brilliance and frustration: I let an AI agent run my day, New Scientist, Your paragraph text

Presentation Outline

1 What are AI Agents?

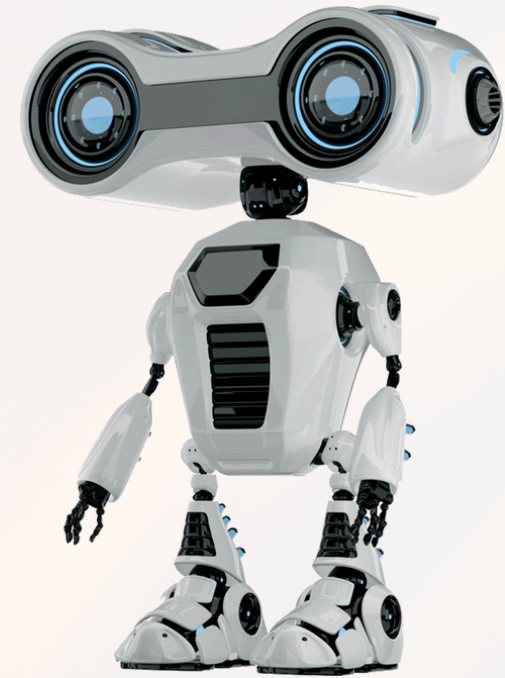
2 The Writer's Test

3 Good Results

4 Problems Found

7 What Experts Say

8 Conclusion



What are AI Agents?

AI agents are a new type of AI assistant that can DO tasks for you, not just give you information.

- Regular AI gives you information and suggestions
- AI agents actually complete tasks automatically
- They work like an "autopilot" instead of a "copilot"
- Examples: order food, send emails, book trips, shop online
- They use web browsers and apps to complete tasks

**CHATBOTS
VS
AI
ASSISTANT
VS
AI AGENT**

**EXPLAINED IN
A SIMPLE WAY**



The Writer's Test

The writer tested two AI agents to see how well they work as personal assistants

Operator

Made by: OpenAI

Known for: ChatGPT technology

Tasks tested: Ordering food, managing invoices, sending emails

Manus

Made by: Butterfly Effect (Chinese start-up)

Status: Beta version

Tasks tested: Reformatting slides, compiling code

The Goal

Use AI agents as personal assistants to do everyday work tasks automatically. This would save time and let the writer focus on more important work.

Good Results



Ordered Food Successfully

Operator ordered kung pao chicken from a restaurant. The food arrived as expected without any problems.



Sent Emails to Experts

Operator wrote and sent emails to researchers. Some experts responded and agreed to interviews for the article.



Compiled Computer Code

Manus successfully compiled code for an app and prepared it in the correct format for an app store.



Saved Some Time

The AI agents completed some tasks without human help, giving the writer more time for other work.

Problems Found



Wrong Invoices

Operator filled out invoice forms incorrectly and suggested charging £8001 for a single article



Bad Emails

Emails were too formal, unfriendly, and missing important information like the publication name

Poor Formatting

Manus put each line of text in a separate box, making slides very hard to edit later



Too Much Checking

The AI needed constant supervision and approval, taking more time than doing tasks yourself

The AI agents worked like junior assistants who made many mistakes and needed constant watching

What Experts Say

Peter Stone

University of Texas at Austin

AI agents are systems that "sense the environment, decide what to do and take an action." They work as autopilot rather than copilot.

Carissa Véliz

University of Oxford

AI agents work for companies before they work for you. Giving them access to all your information makes them "very unsafe."

Tianshi Li

Northeastern University

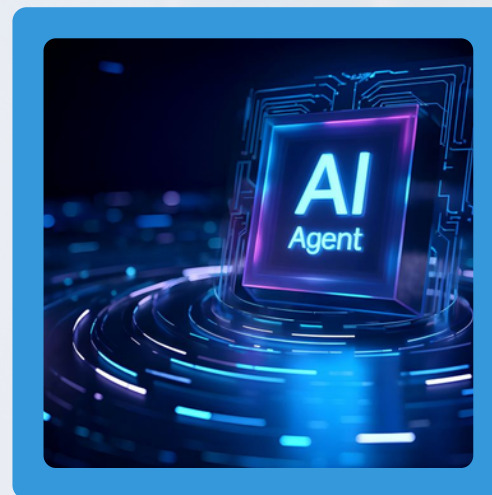
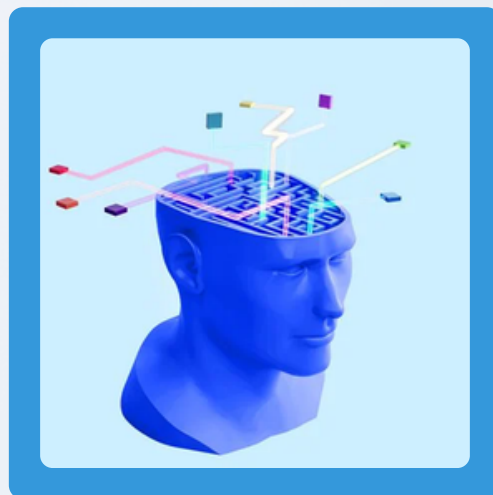
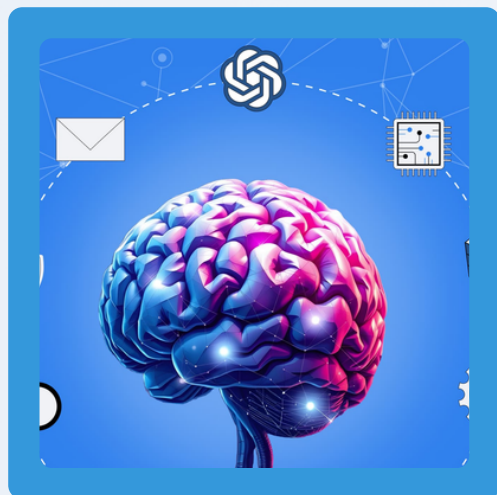
AI agents can be tricked easily by simple commands hidden in text. There is no effective way to stop this or warn users.

Colin Jarvis

OpenAI

"We're still in the early days" of AI agents. The technology "still needs quite a bit of work to get that reliability."

Conclusion



- 1 AI agents show promise for helping with everyday tasks
- 2 Current versions are not ready for everyday use
- 3 They make too many mistakes and need constant watching
- 4 Privacy and security risks are serious concerns
- 5 The technology needs more work before we can trust it

AI agents are the future, but that future is not here yet



Questions

Thank you for your
attention